

BEAUTY OF BEACHES

NORTH • WEST • EAST
Famous Beaches Information Guide

A simple travel-style guide prepared for the BeautyOfBeaches project. It covers six beaches across the North, West and East zones.

NORTH ZONE

Reynisfjara Beach

Location: Near Vík í Mýrdal, Iceland

Introduction: Reynisfjara is one of Iceland's most famous black-sand beaches. It is known for volcanic sand, dramatic basalt columns, powerful Atlantic waves and striking sea stacks.

What makes it special?

- Unique black sand created by volcanic activity.
- Famous basalt column formations at the cliffs.
- Dramatic Reynisdrangar sea stacks rising from the ocean.
- Wild coastal scenery and powerful Atlantic waves.
- Excellent location for landscape photography and sightseeing.

Popular Activities: Beach walking, sightseeing, photography and enjoying the dramatic coastal scenery.

Why tourists visit: Visitors come to see Iceland's unique volcanic landscape, black sand, basalt cliffs and famous sea stacks.

Ideal for: Adventure seekers & photographers

Uttakleiv Beach

Location: Vestvågøy, Lofoten Islands, Norway

Introduction: Uttakleiv Beach is a beautiful Arctic beach in Norway's Lofoten Islands. It is famous for clear waters, pale sand, rocky shoreline and dramatic mountain scenery.

What makes it special?

- Clear turquoise-blue water and pale sandy shoreline.
- Dramatic Lofoten mountains surrounding the beach.
- Large smooth rocks create a distinctive Arctic landscape.

- Beautiful views of the Norwegian Sea.
- Excellent destination for landscape and nature photography.

Popular Activities: Relaxing, photography, beach walks, hiking nearby trails and, in suitable seasons, viewing the Northern Lights.

Why tourists visit: Visitors come to experience the peaceful Arctic scenery, mountains, beaches and unique natural landscapes of the Lofoten Islands.

Ideal for: Nature lovers & photographers

QUICK COMPARISON

Feature	Reynisfjara Beach	Uttakleiv Beach
Country	Iceland	Norway
Main attraction	Unique black sand created by volcanic activity.	Clear turquoise-blue water and pale sandy shoreline.
Popular activities	Beach walking, sightseeing, photography and enjoying the relaxing atmosphere.	Relaxing, photography, beach walks, hiking nearby trails and, in suitable seasons, viewing the Northern Lights.
Ideal for	Adventure seekers & photographers	Nature lovers & photographers

WEST ZONE

Copacabana Beach

Location: Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Introduction: Copacabana Beach is one of Brazil's most famous beaches. It is known for its wide sandy shoreline, Atlantic Ocean views, lively atmosphere and beautiful Rio de Janeiro surroundings.

What makes it special?

- Wide sandy beach with beautiful ocean views.
- Famous curved waterfront and lively beach atmosphere.
- Beautiful views of Rio de Janeiro's mountains and coastline.
- Popular for walking, cycling, relaxing and photography.
- Well known for large celebrations and public events.

Popular Activities: Walking, cycling, beach sports, photography, sightseeing and relaxing.

Why tourists visit: Tourists come to enjoy Rio de Janeiro's famous beach culture, scenery, waterfront atmosphere and nearby attractions.

Ideal for: City travelers & beach lovers

Malibu Beach

Location: Malibu, California, United States

Introduction: Malibu is a famous coastal area in Southern California. It is known for its Pacific Ocean coastline, sandy beaches, coastal hills and strong connection with surfing and outdoor recreation.

What makes it special?

- Beautiful Pacific Ocean coastline and sandy beaches.
- Famous surfing culture and scenic coastal views.
- Dramatic hills and cliffs along parts of the coastline.
- Malibu Pier is a well-known landmark.
- Popular for photography, beach walks and sunsets.

Popular Activities: Surfing, beach walks, photography, sightseeing, relaxing and enjoying coastal scenery.

Why tourists visit: Visitors enjoy Malibu's beautiful coastline, surf culture, scenic views and relaxed California beach atmosphere.

Ideal for: Surfers, photographers & coastal travelers

QUICK COMPARISON

Feature	Copacabana Beach	Malibu Beach
Country	Brazil	United States
Main attraction	Wide sandy beach with beautiful ocean views.	Beautiful Pacific Ocean coastline and sandy beaches.
Popular activities	Walking, cycling, beach sports, photography, sightseeing	Surfing, beach walks, photography, sightseeing, relaxing and enjoying coastal views.
Ideal for	City travelers & beach lovers	Surfers, photographers & coastal travelers

EAST ZONE

Maya Bay

Location: Ko Phi Phi Leh, Krabi Province, Thailand

Introduction: Maya Bay in Thailand's Phi Phi Islands is a world-famous natural attraction known for its clear turquoise water, white sandy beach and tall limestone cliffs. Maya Bay also gained international fame because of the film *The Beach*.

What makes it special?

- Crystal-clear turquoise water and soft white sand.
- Tall limestone cliffs create a natural amphitheatre-like setting.
- Beautiful marine environment and surrounding tropical nature.
- Famous destination for photography and scenic sightseeing.
- Important part of the Phi Phi Islands and national-park environment.

Popular Activities: Sightseeing, photography, boat tours, island exploration and permitted marine activities.

Why tourists visit: Visitors come to experience Maya Bay's natural beauty, turquoise water, limestone cliffs and the famous Phi Phi Islands.

Ideal for: Nature lovers & photographers

Important note: Maya Bay may have visitor rules and seasonal closures for environmental protection. Check current official local guidance before visiting.

Haeundae Beach

Location: Haeundae-gu, Busan, South Korea

Introduction: Haeundae Beach is South Korea's most famous and well-known beach. It is known for its wide sandy shoreline, clear water, modern city skyline and convenient tourist facilities.

What makes it special?

- Wide sandy beach and beautiful coastal views.
- Modern Busan city skyline directly behind the beach.
- Tourist information, restrooms, showers, changing rooms and parking.
- Popular for seasonal events, performances and festivals.
- Located close to famous urban attractions in Busan.

Popular Activities: Swimming in designated areas, sandy walks, sightseeing, photography, seasonal events and enjoying the waterfront.

Why tourists visit: Haeundae combines nature and modern city life in one location, making it popular with families, local visitors and international tourists.

Ideal for: Families & city travelers

Important note: For swimming, follow designated-area and lifeguard instructions.

QUICK COMPARISON

Feature	Maya Bay	Haeundae Beach
Country	Thailand	South Korea
Main attraction	Crystal-clear turquoise water and soft white sand.	Wide sandy beach and beautiful coastal views.
Popular activities	Sightseeing, photography, boat tours, island exploration	Swimming in designated areas, sandy walks, sightseeing, photography, se
Ideal for	Nature lovers & photographers	Families & city travelers

RESPONSIBLE BEACH VISITS

- Check current local information before travelling or entering the water.
- Follow lifeguard instructions, designated swimming areas and beach safety signs.
- Respect wildlife, other visitors and the surrounding coastal environment.
- Keep beaches clean and dispose of rubbish properly.
- Protect yourself from strong sun and stay hydrated.

Prepared for the BeautyOfBeaches project — North, West & East Zones.